

LESSONS FROM THE GIANT KILLER

JOHN CRADDOCK



How to overcome and become the Hero in your Story

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Introduction

Welcome to Lessons from a Giant Killer. This book will build your faith while motivating your mind using the Biblical record of David's victory over Goliath. Each page expounds on a life-changing principle. Each highlight gives you a principle that, if practiced, will make you into the winner you are destined to be. This book will help you become your own hero in your life's story. This little book is to be read and reread. Grab it again when you are beginning to feel discouraged or defeated. Build yourself up by finding inspiration in its pages.

This book has a blessing on it that can be transferred to you. Are you ready to feed and fuel the winner in you? Victory is a choice, and so is starting. Get started.

“Questions are the Answer”

1 Samuel 17:26 “And David spake to the men that stood by him, saying, What shall be done to the man that killeth this Philistine, and taketh away the reproach from Israel? for who is this uncircumcised Philistine, that he should defy the armies of the living God?”

When David arrives on the scene, he is not frightened by what he sees and hears from Goliath, so he begins to ask questions about *what would happen if someone defeated the menace*. **Notice from the start he was thinking in faith because he was asking positive questions.** It was not if someone loses what happens, although that would seem obvious. It was what happens when someone defeats Goliath. It wasn't; how come no one has succeeded? Or what if I fail? **He asked a question out of faith, no doubt! David only allowed himself to think in terms of succeeding!**

One of the most powerful tools God has given us is the ability to ask questions! However, like most things, it can be used in a *constructive way* or in a *destructive way*. **We can ask questions of others and ourselves that build our faith or that create doubt! We can ask questions that cause us to think about succeeding, and we can ask questions that make us think about failing. We can even ask God questions that sow doubt and create confusion.**

The questions are the answers. The questions are the answer to building our faith and unlocking our potential. If we ask questions in faith, we will produce answers out of faith! If we ask positive questions, we will get positive answers!

Ask: What will be the reward when I succeed? How can I do what no one else has done? What has happened in the past that proves I can succeed at this? In David's case, it was protecting his flock from a bear and a lion. Ask: What if I succeed? As opposed to What if I fail? Ask: How do I know God will help me? Versus: What if God doesn't help me?

Jesus said, "Ask, and you will receive." We get what we ask for! If we ask in doubt, we get doubt! If we ask in faith, we get faith and its reward!

“The Faith Factor”

1 Samuel 17: 50 “So David prevailed over the Philistine with a sling and with a stone, and smote the Philistine, and slew him; but there was no sword in the hand of David.”

Here’s the thought I want us to focus on today. “The Faith Factor”

1 Samuel 17: 50 “So David prevailed over the Philistine with a sling and with a stone, and smote the Philistine, and slew him; but there was no sword in the hand of David.”

Here’s the thought I want us to focus on today. When you have faith, a sling and stones are enough, but when you are afraid, a whole army isn’t enough! Saul had a whole army but was *paralyzed by fear* of doom if he or any of his soldiers tried to defeat this Giant. David, *thinking in faith*, saw the Giant as beatable and the victory as a matter of fact!

The truth of the matter is that when we are afraid of a negative outcome, we procrastinate and make excuses for not attacking. When we have faith, we are proactive and execute! We attack because we believe in a victorious outcome.

Fear can make anyone a coward! A battle-tested King or a whole army can be reduced to excuse-making, passing up the responsibility that is in front of them! A leader (king) can be reduced to buying or bribing his followers as opposed to leading them or even commanding them.

Faith can make anyone a conqueror! The Bible and history are full of unlikely heroes. *Ordinary people who did great things because they had extraordinary faith!* David was the least likely giant killer, but his faith qualified him. Everything else about David disqualified him, but he was not going to make excuses. **Instead of making excuses, he became the exception!** The one who *acted in faith* while everyone else *reacted in fear*. **Often, we are like Saul and Israel, waiting in fear.** We wait for a good time or a better day. Maybe, for more skill or even someone else to do what we know we should. Yet, we are not sure we can, so we will wait. **The fact is until we move from fear to faith, nothing will break the pattern of procrastination.** Faith is proactive! It doesn't make excuses. It executes!

Saul had a whole army but was *paralyzed by fear* of doom if he or any of his soldiers tried to defeat this Giant. David, *thinking in faith*, saw the Giant as beatable and the victory as a matter of fact!

“The Faith Factor 2”

1 Samuel 17:3 "And the Philistines stood on a mountain on the one side, and Israel stood on a mountain on the other side: and there was a valley between them."

As we examine how **The Faith Factor made a difference in David's Attitude and Actions versus the Attitude and lack of Actions of Saul and his soldiers**, some lessons will be obvious. In our text, we see that there was a valley that would separate Israel from Goliath. It was like an invisible barrier keeping them from overcoming the Giant who taunted and intimidated them. **In reality, it wasn't the valley that was keeping them from overcoming Goliath; it was their fear.** Verse 11 says Saul and his soldiers were "greatly afraid."

Contrast their fear to little David, who, according to verse 48, *runs toward* the Giant that everyone else *ran from*. "And it came to pass, when the Philistine arose, and came, and drew nigh to meet David, that David hastened, and ran toward the army to meet the Philistine." **David believes he is running to victory! Saul and his men believed they were running away from inevitable defeat.** The *different factor* was David's *faith*!

The valley might as well have been 1,000 miles wide. Israel's soldiers did not want to cross over to face Goliath. *The only thing keeping them from victory was their fear and doubts.* **Many of us have a valley separating us from a victory in our lives as well.** *The only thing that is really separating us from where we are and what needs to be defeated is our doubts and fears.* We aren't acting because we think like the soldiers, seeing certain failures if we dare try. When we have faith like David's and believe the outcome will actually be positive,

we will attack! Until then, we will keep a valley between us and the Giant we need to conquer.

It would be a starting point for us to realize that our excuses and procrastination are because we fear the outcome. When we believe that the outcome will be bad, we remain stationary. We would charge forward and attack if we believed we would have a positive outcome. **We are either proactive because of The Faith Factor or inactive because of The Fear Factor. The Fear Factor makes us run from, and The Faith Factor makes us run toward!**

“The Faith Factor 3”

1 Samuel 17:36-37 “Thy servant slew both the lion and the bear: and this uncircumcised Philistine shall be as one of them, seeing he hath defied the armies of the living God. David said moreover, The LORD that delivered me out of the paw of the lion, and out of the paw of the bear, he will deliver me out of the hand of this Philistine.”

It is apparent when reviewing the whole chapter of 1 Samuel 17 that David views the whole matter with Goliath differently than Saul and his soldiers did. Why? It is because of The Faith Factor. David viewed it all through faith, and it gave him *confidence in God* and *in himself*. David wasn't talking in terms of *trying* but in *doing*. Looking at the text above and paraphrasing, he says I will win! God will help!

What I believe determines what I see! David saw victory. The others saw defeat. He saw his past as a reason to believe he would succeed in this matter. The soldiers and Saul, who all had more victories in their lives than David, still saw failure facing the Giant. David saw the Giant as an offense to God and was motivated to do something about it. The others saw the Giant as an obstacle God wouldn't help them overcome. They were unmotivated.

What I believe determines how I see! David saw a positive outcome. The others saw defeat and death! David saw the same things they saw but was *inspired to act*. They saw the size of the Giant, his spear, and his sword and became so *intimidated they couldn't act*. David saw a few wins in his past as *a reason to believe God* would help him win over the Giant. The others saw the past victories and doubted God would help them again.

What we believe determines what and how we see as well. Then, that view determines our attitude. Our attitude then will determine our actions! It even determines our attitude toward God.

“The Faith Factor 4”

1 Samuel 17:36-37 “Thy servant slew both the lion and the bear: and this uncircumcised Philistine shall be as one of them, seeing he hath defied the armies of the living God. David said moreover, The LORD that delivered me out of the paw of the lion, and out of the paw of the bear, he will deliver me out of the hand of this Philistine.”

In the last devotion, we explored the fact that *David's belief determined how he viewed (mentally) the situation with Goliath*. He believed God would grant him a positive outcome, so that caused his attitude to be different from Saul's and his Army's. **So David's belief created his attitude, which was the catalyst for his actions! His belief determined his behavior!** Saul and the soldier's negative belief determined their behavior as well. They believed defeat would be the outcome and so behaved accordingly. They didn't try because they foresaw their defeat and death. These experienced warriors, men of valor, became men who were dominated by fear. They behaved in fear while this inexperienced kid came on the scene full of faith and acted like a warrior! The difference in their behavior was their belief.

Get this lesson, too. They all believed in God, but it was what they believed, particularly personally, that made the difference. Saul and his soldiers believed God wouldn't help them defeat Goliath. David believed God would give him victory! **It wasn't their general belief that determined their behavior. It was their specific belief about that situation.**

The Truth applies to us as well. **Our beliefs determine our behavior. Our specific beliefs determine our specific behavior in a given**

circumstance. Believing God could help you defeat a Giant will create one behavior, not one of confidence. Believing God Will help you defeat the Giant will create another behavior. It will create behavior like David's. **You'll behave with confidence and certainty when you believe with confidence and certainty!**

Important: If the behavior is negative, it means the belief (specific) is negative! If the behavior is lacking, then the belief is lacking!

“The Faith Factor 5”

1 Samuel 17:49-50 “And David put his hand in his bag, and took thence a stone, and slang it, and smote the Philistine in his forehead, that the stone sunk into his forehead; and he fell upon his face to the earth. So David prevailed over the Philistine with a sling and with a stone, and smote the Philistine, and slew him;”

David’s faith was the greatest factor in his victory. His faith influenced his *attitude* and inspired his *actions*. His confident belief created his confident behavior. **Now, seeing his faith allows God to use his skills to accomplish something extraordinary.** God does not give him some new skill but uses the skill he already possesses to accomplish this huge victory. His unintimidating talent with a sling was used to bring deliverance to Israel while changing his own life forever. He became an instant leader of men twice his age.

His faith allowed God to use an ordinary talent for a shepherd in an extraordinary way. When we have faith, any skill can be used to accomplish great things. ***Without faith, all the skills and talents we possess will never accomplish great things.*** Israel’s army was full of skilled and talented soldiers with a winning resume. Yet, because they lacked faith, all that skill and talent went to waste. **Faith is more important than skill or talent because God can bless it and use it!**

It seems we are waiting to accomplish something because we think we lack the skills and talents needed. **It is more likely we *actually lack the faith*, not the skill.** God can use what we already have to **change our lives and help make the lives of others better!** Some skill or talent that is *already evident in your life* can be *the key to a great*

victory for you and others! **The ordinary, even common, talent becomes special when it is used in faith!**

God wants to make more of what you already have and know. **He is waiting on you to believe and behave like you believe.** He isn't waiting for you to perfect your skill or talent. **Just Use It!**

“The Faith Factor 6”

1 Samuel 17:49-50 “And David put his hand in his bag, and took thence a stone, and slang it, and smote the Philistine in his forehead, that the stone sunk into his forehead; and he fell upon his face to the earth. So David prevailed over the Philistine with a sling and with a stone, and smote the Philistine, and slew him;”

Notice this: “So David prevailed”. He didn’t prevail as a master sling shooter but because of his faith! (Hebrew 11:32-34) **It is important to see that faith was the factor in his overcoming the Giant.** The same is true in our lives. Whatever we need to prevail over faith is how it will happen. It is God’s plan!

The term prevailed, revealing that God used David to solve the problem of the menace named Goliath. God couldn’t bless the inactivity of Saul and his soldiers, but as soon as *someone believed it could be done, it was*. I assume Saul or some of his army prayed for God to solve the problem that was Goliath, but it was *David’s faith and fight* that God used to prevail. **God wants to use us to prevail and solve our problems.** David prevailed where others failed. Why? He believed! **He went into the fight, presuming the victory! They stayed out of the fight, presuming failure!**

It is most likely whatever it is that you need to prevail over, God will use you to do it when you believe you can. It is also most likely if you never believe you can, you never will. Many never get past the Giant and live life “dismayed and greatly afraid”. They are taunted day after day by the thing that is bullying them and mocking their faith in God. God wants us to be our own deliverer and hero as we believe in Him. So maybe it's time to stop looking for

someone to save you or solve your problem and make it happen for yourself, believing God will help you prevail!

Today, we are all standing on a mountain looking at some Giant that needs to prevail over down in the valley. The question is, who will become a hero of faith today? Who will prevail? **Who will prevail as others fail?**

“Faith Robbers”

1 Samuel 17:28 “And Eliab his eldest brother heard when he spake unto the men; and Eliab's anger was kindled against David, and he said, Why camest thou down hither? and with whom hast thou left those few sheep in the wilderness? I know thy pride, and the naughtiness of thine heart; for thou art come down that thou mightest see the battle.” 1 Samuel 17:33” And Saul said to David, Thou art not able to go against this Philistine to fight with him: for thou art but a youth, and he a man of war from his youth.”

As David asked his questions, we revealed two things that can rob us of our faith if we are not on guard against them. **The first faith robber is criticism.** David's oldest brother criticizes his motive and character. He also tries to minimize David's role as a shepherd, which is a form of putting him down. **The second faith robber is the doubting or negative comments of others.** Saul says *you can't* defeat Goliath. Saul also points out David's apparent weakness, which was his youth and inexperience. Further, Saul magnifies the problem and danger of Goliath.

David, in both cases, responds to their negativity with a positive response. He then immediately focuses on the solution and not the criticism and doubt of his authority figures. He refused to have his focus or faith diluted by their fear. People who criticize do so out of their own insecurities, fears, and failures. Saul and Eliab were both afraid of Goliath, so they saw the whole situation out of their fear. We don't see things as they are but as we are. So, that means if they are negative, they will see people, circumstances, and opportunities from that perspective. They will even view God from that

perspective. David came from the opposite perspective, so he had to protect himself from their negative communications.

We all need to be on guard from the criticism of those who are negative. Some people may not even recognize their negative comments because they are so pervasive in their lives. We still have to be alert because, before we know it, these comments can sneak into our minds and rob us of our faith! **We also need to be on guard against those who say we can't do something. *Really, what they mean is they can't or will not do whatever it is.*** Yet, if we aren't diligent in protecting our faith, their doubts will take root in our minds.

Take note of this. The doubts and criticisms were sown by **important people in David's life.** It was from his Family. It was from his Authorities and more than likely from his Heroes. I'm pretty certain David looked up to his oldest brother, who was an experienced warrior in battle. He no doubt admired the King, who was the tallest man in Israel and a hero in battle. **Be alert to the fact that those who sow doubt in you are those who have the most influence in your lives!**

“Faith’s Motives”

I Samuel 17:43-47 “And the Philistine said unto David, Am I a dog, that thou comest to me with staves? And the Philistine cursed David by his gods. And the Philistine said to David, Come to me, and I will give thy flesh unto the fowls of the air, and to the beasts of the field. Then said David to the Philistine, Thou comest to me with a sword, and with a spear, and with a shield: but I come to thee in the name of the LORD of hosts, the God of the armies of Israel, whom thou hast defied. This day will the LORD deliver thee into mine hand; and I will smite thee, and take thine head from thee; and I will give the carcasses of the host of the Philistines this day unto the fowls of the air, and to the wild beasts of the earth; that all the earth may know that there is a God in Israel. And all this assembly shall know that the LORD saveth not with sword and spear: for the battle is the LORD's, and he will give you into our hands.”

Before we leave this portion of the text, it is important for us to see that **David’s motives were not totally personal**. Sure, he asked about the reward that would be given to the person who defeated Goliath, and that could have been some motivation. When he is facing Goliath, we see the heart of the matter, which is his heart. His motives were right. He wanted God to be magnified “...that all the earth may know that there is a God in Israel.” His motive was that his God would be glorified through his victory! Also, he wanted his army, which was full of fear, to realize they should have faith in their God, “...this assembly shall know that the LORD saveth not with sword and spear: for the battle is the LORD's, and he will give you into our hands.” He wasn’t selfish in believing in God for the victory. It would bless God and benefit others!

One reason our faith isn't producing could be our motives are wrong. God will not bless us when our motives are impure or only for selfish reasons. That would lead to God enabling our dysfunction. Further, on a deep level, we probably know our motives are wrong, and that keeps us from *completely believing* as David did.

I'm not suggesting God will not bless us with the desires of our hearts, but it is when we "delight" in Him. **If we delight in Him, we will have the motive of magnifying and bringing honor to Him through our victories and successes!** (Psalms 37:4)

Our motive should also be to benefit others in some way. It can be to help them believe through our victory like David's was. Or to help them overcome an obstacle that is holding them back. Our motive should be to bless or benefit someone else somehow through our faith and its reward.

When our motives are *aligned with God's purpose*, we will experience *God's power*! When our motives are aligned with God's plan, we will become God's partner. Then, we do things beyond our own abilities.

“Faith’s Influence”

1 Samuel 17:51-53 “Therefore David ran, and stood upon the Philistine, and took his sword, and drew it out of the sheath thereof, and slew him, and cut off his head therewith. And when the Philistines saw their champion was dead, they fled. And the men of Israel and of Judah arose, and shouted, and pursued the Philistines, until thou come to the valley, and to the gates of Ekron. And the wounded of the Philistines fell down by the way to Shaaraim, even unto Gath, and unto Ekron. And the children of Israel returned from chasing after the Philistines, and they spoiled their tents.”

Notice how David’s victory over Goliath influenced Israel’s army to action. It was not David’s words, although they were spoken in faith. *They were moved and motivated by the sight of David’s victory over Goliath.* On the opposite side, the Philistines were moved to run in fear. **The real influence of David’s faith was what it enabled or empowered him to do.**

The point of this devotion is simple but significant. People who are for our faith or who oppose it will not be influenced by our words as much as they will be by our actions. **When people can see how our faith enables and empowers us, they will be influenced.** When we say God can do great things, it has little impact, but when people can see God does great things through us, the *influence factor increases.*

When Israel’s army saw how God blessed David’s faith, they couldn’t help but believe they would be victorious, too! David could have stayed on the hillside with them and given a tremendous motivational talk about what God had done in the past and why

they should fight for God's honor, but it wouldn't have worked. **Yet, his victory was worth a thousand speeches!**

We are sermon-rich today but victory poor. We hear and hear, talk and talk, all while our influence decreases. What we need is some victories! **We need some people who will have faith that *enables* and *empowers* them to do or be extraordinary.** People will be *moved* and *motivated* when they see a shepherd boy defeat a Giant. **A victory is worth a thousand sermons or speeches.**

“The Conversation of a Conqueror”

I Samuel 17:43-47 “And the Philistine said unto David, Am I a dog, that thou comest to me with staves? And the Philistine cursed David by his gods. And the Philistine said to David, Come to me, and I will give thy flesh unto the fowls of the air, and to the beasts of the field. Then said David to the Philistine, Thou comest to me with a sword, and with a spear, and with a shield: but I come to thee in the name of the LORD of hosts, the God of the armies of Israel, whom thou hast defied. This day will the LORD deliver thee into mine hand; and I will smite thee, and take thine head from thee; and I will give the carcases of the host of the Philistines this day unto the fowls of the air, and to the wild beasts of the earth; that all the earth may know that there is a God in Israel. And all this assembly shall know that the LORD saveth not with sword and spear: for the battle is the LORD's, and he will give you into our hands.”

David's conversation with the Giant is worth examining, for **the battle is often won and lost in the conversation**. What we say and *how we respond* to the negativity and hostility of others will either reinforce our faith or weaken it.

Goliath attacked David with words before he tried to attack him with weapons. Words have always been used to undermine an opponent's confidence and resolve. Also, many people sabotage themselves with their own words. Words have a profound effect on our psychology. **If doubt or fear can be sown in the mind, half the battle is won.** Goliath was “a man of war”. He knew how to use everything to defeat, terrorize, and weaken his opponents.

Looking at the conversation, we see it was a battle of faiths. Goliath cursed David and defied God by his gods. He was implying David's God was weak because no one could defeat him. He was sowing doubt at the core of David's belief. He was trying to undermine David's faith!

Understand, first and foremost, we need to become acutely aware that our faith is always being attacked! Words are weapons. The challenge is because they are invisible, they can wound our confidence and faith covertly. Remember, it is not only "Goliaths" that use words; it may be a family member or an authority figure. It can be *disguised as advice* or a frontal attack. David had to overcome both. Most likely, we will, too!

In the next devotion, we will look at how David overcame verbal warfare with a conversation of a conqueror.

“The Conversation of a Conqueror 2”

I Samuel 17:43-47 “And the Philistine said unto David, Am I a dog, that thou comest to me with staves? And the Philistine cursed David by his gods. And the Philistine said to David, Come to me, and I will give thy flesh unto the fowls of the air, and to the beasts of the field. Then said David to the Philistine, Thou comest to me with a sword, and with a spear, and with a shield: but I come to thee in the name of the LORD of hosts, the God of the armies of Israel, whom thou hast defied. This day will the LORD deliver thee into mine hand; and I will smite thee, and take thine head from thee; and I will give the carcases of the host of the Philistines this day unto the fowls of the air, and to the wild beasts of the earth; that all the earth may know that there is a God in Israel. And all this assembly shall know that the LORD saveth not with sword and spear: for the battle is the LORD's, and he will give you into our hands.”

Again, *words are weapons!* They can be used against us, or we can use them against what is attacking us. We can be *victims of the words* of others, or we can *use them to be victorious*. David's brief conversation with Goliath reveals how a Conqueror talks.

David overcame Goliath's words of doubt by speaking words of faith. David said this day, God WILL give me the victory. I WILL smite you. I WILL give your body to vultures. People Will KNOW God has helped me! God WILL give you to me in battle. *David sent back in faith everything Goliath said to cause doubt, stating with confidence and certainty what he needed to happen!*

David overcame Goliath's words of defeat by speaking of victory. David talked *as if the victory was certain* in spite of the facts. The facts

were that Goliath was undefeated, gigantic in size, and he was inexperienced in real combat. There was no room for being double-minded. This was life or death! The victory was a *must*, so he talked like it was a fact.

David overcame Goliath's words of discouragement by only speaking of the outcome he wanted to create. *David didn't even acknowledge the possibility of losing this battle.* If he gave fear any opening at all, he would be vulnerable. Words create mental images, so if he spoke them, he would see them **in his** mind. Even a brief image is enough to sow doubt. In fact, he actually turned Goliath's mental image around and sent it back to Goliath by saying he would cut off Goliath's head and feed his army to the vultures. That was way more powerful than what Goliath had said to him. He spoke of what seemed to be an unbelievable outcome, but *he said it like he believed it!*

As you read the passage over with this perspective, see how David won the battle of words. **He used his words as weapons and conquered Goliath in conversation before he let go of the rock.**

“The Conversation of a Conqueror 3”

I Samuel 17:43-47 “And the Philistine said unto David, Am I a dog, that thou comest to me with staves? And the Philistine cursed David by his gods. And the Philistine said to David, Come to me, and I will give thy flesh unto the fowls of the air, and to the beasts of the field. Then said David to the Philistine, Thou comest to me with a sword, and with a spear, and with a shield: but I come to thee in the name of the LORD of hosts, the God of the armies of Israel, whom thou hast defied. This day will the LORD deliver thee into mine hand; and I will smite thee, and take thine head from thee; and I will give the carcases of the host of the Philistines this day unto the fowls of the air, and to the wild beasts of the earth; that all the earth may know that there is a God in Israel. And all this assembly shall know that the LORD saveth not with sword and spear: for the battle is the LORD's, and he will give you into our hands.”

It is imperative that we learn to speak as David did in this confrontation with Goliath. I would suggest David never had more faith and certainty than at that moment. His conversation with Goliath is a model for us to observe and practice. **Speaking as he spoke will help produce faith and confidence in God as well as in ourselves.**

He stated things as facts. He says the LORD will. I will. **He stated what hadn't happened yet as if it was ALREADY a fact!** That is what faith does. How did he know God would? How did he know he would be victorious? He believed! God didn't give him a sign. He just chose to believe.

He stated the outcome he desired. *He only talked of winning, succeeding, and prevailing.* When the King doubted him, he stated with confidence the positive outcome. When Goliath talked of defeat, he *made clear, confident statements of being victorious!*

He stated everything with confidence. *He spoke to everyone, especially his foe, with confidence and conviction.* He never hesitated. It wasn't arrogance. It was faith! He knew God was going to help him, and that gave him personal confidence.

We need to get the concept that faith makes statements! Doubt asks questions. Faith talks as if! *Doubt talks about what if. David talked as if the victory was a fact.* Doubt talks about what if I don't win. Faith states what it desires from God! *Doubt asks will God? Faith says God's Will.* Doubt always asks, what if it's not God's will? Faith knows it is God's will. **Faith speaks with confidence and conviction! Doubt speaks with confusion.** Faith speaks of only One possibility!

Conquerors (winners) talk about achieving victory. What will happen when I prevail, not what will happen if I don't? Remember, Jesus said with faith, command, and demand, and it will happen! See: Matthew 17:20, 21:21

“Vicious in Victory”

I Samuel 17:50-51 “So David prevailed over the Philistine with a sling and with a stone, and smote the Philistine, and slew him; but there was no sword in the hand of David. Therefore David ran, and stood upon the Philistine, and took his sword, and drew it out of the sheath thereof, and slew him, and cut off his head therewith. And when the Philistines saw their champion was dead, they fled.”

Varying from the faith theme, I feel it led to pointing out David's characteristics **as a winner**. It may seem hard for us to process this, but **David was vicious in his victory**. He had to be sure Goliath was *not only defeated* but that *he was dead!* He had to make certain that Goliath's army could see that their great champion was dead and done.

I've observed successful people from all eras and pursuits. **I've observed they are all like David; they are vicious in victory. They all have the killer instinct when it is necessary.** Like David, most are kind outside of the moment of confrontation, but when it's time to draw the sword, they are going to destroy, not just defeat. They want to close the door or deal. It is done with 100% commitment! No hesitation! *If it's necessary, then do it with devastating power and precision.*

Too many get to the point of complete victory and stop just short. We are *content with knocking the Giant down* but don't take that *final blow* or *the last step*. Only to realize in time the Giant has come back from defeat and is more determined than ever to destroy us. This time, he knows about our sling, so it will not work again. **We keep**

struggling to defeat things over and over because we didn't destroy them!

We get to the place like David of having a life-changing victory, and we fail to do all that is needed to ensure the victory. We may do 9 out of 10 things but *stop just a little short of total success*. We get soft when we need to be vicious in victory.

Some things and some people can not be compromised with or capitulated to. Is it your victory or theirs? Is it your life or death? **When it comes to these moments, you better be vicious in victory, or you will *be a victim of victory*!** They or it will not be merciful to you.

“How to Get Recognized and Rewarded”

1 Samuel 17:55-58 “And when Saul saw David go forth against the Philistine, he said unto Abner, the captain of the host, Abner, whose son is this youth? And Abner said, As thy soul liveth, O king, I cannot tell. And the king said, Enquire thou whose son the stripling is. And as David returned from the slaughter of the Philistine, Abner took him, and brought him before Saul with the head of the Philistine in his hand. And Saul said to him, Whose son art thou, thou young man? And David answered, I am the son of thy servant Jesse the Bethlehemite.”

After David’s victory, he is brought before the king. Fresh from the battle, he finds himself standing before the king as a conquering hero. **David’s life changes so quickly, from tending his father’s sheep out in the wilderness to being recognized and rewarded by the king.**

David was recognized because he did what others wouldn’t. He defeated the Goliath and, in the process, caused himself to stand out. The person who can overcome what others are defeated by will stand out. The man or woman who can take action when others are making excuses will eventually be recognized and rewarded.

David was recognized because he did what others couldn’t. *He got himself to believe while others were full of doubt, so he succeeded at what they couldn’t do.* He achieved what everyone else was saying, and thinking was impossible. **If a man, woman, or teenager can do what others think they can’t, they will be recognized, respected, and rewarded.**

David was recognized because he solved a problem. *David eliminated a huge obstacle for King Saul when he defeated Goliath. He instantly improved the morale of the King's army and created momentum.* Every leader knows Momentum is essential in achieving any success. So David helped the King in 3 huge ways. He removed a physical problem called Goliath. He removed the paralysis of fear and negative emotion that had captured the army. He kick-started the battle with his win over Goliath and created positive momentum. **The person who can solve a problem will be rewarded and recognized.** *The larger the problem that is solved, the larger the reward will be.*

If you want to stand out, then do what others can't or *what they won't do.* **Solve a problem.** *Become the solution,* and you will stand out. *Change the morale of those around you for the good, or create positive momentum,* and people will notice you. Then reward will follow. The quickest way to get promoted is to kill a giant.

“An Overview of a Person Who Had Faith”

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As David stands before the King, his life has dramatically changed. He is now a hero. He is respected by soldiers and important leaders in Israel. He knows that God will, in fact, use him in extraordinary ways. He has experienced victory in battle. He has caused himself to stand out and is being recognized and rewarded by the King himself. He went from being an unknown shepherd to being known as David, the Giant Killer. **All of these changes and more were brought about because he had faith, which caused him to act.**

David saw an opportunity that day. *He saw an opportunity to do something for God.* He saw victory, whereas others saw defeat. He saw success where they saw only the possibility of failure. **People who have faith see things differently from the majority.** They see opportunity where most see obstacles. They see reward, whereas others only see risk. They see a big challenge as an opportunity for God to show up and help them. People who have faith are energized, even excited at what they see.

David seized an opportunity that day. He seized the chance to do something great for God. *He seized an opportunity while others shrank from fear* of the challenge. He took action while they were waiting for something to happen. He ran forward where they retreated. **People who have faith, like David, take action, while most are inactive due to fear.** They charge at a challenge. *They are winning while others are waiting.*

People who have faith, like David, don't have more capabilities, but they believe while those with more capabilities sit on the sideline. **They use their abilities because they have faith,** while others who are more skilled, educated, and talented sit watching in amazement. People who have faith are busy doing what most are saying can't be done. They are winning at the very thing some are saying can't be won! **They are doing it while others are doubting!**

“Vicious in Victory”

I Samuel 17:50-51 “So David prevailed over the Philistine with a sling and with a stone, and smote the Philistine, and slew him; but there was no sword in the hand of David. Therefore David ran, and stood upon the Philistine, and took his sword, and drew it out of the sheath thereof, and slew him, and cut off his head therewith. And when the Philistines saw their champion was dead, they fled.”

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Bonus notes: "A God Confidence"

Psalms 3:8 "Salvation (victory) belongeth unto the LORD: thy blessing is upon thy people. Selah.

Years later, David is facing another enemy. Actually, his son, but the Source of his confidence is still the same. It is in God. He realized that salvation and success in battle came from God. **He had confidence in God, and that produced in him a God-confidence.** Even when the odds were overwhelming, *he maintained his confidence* in God and confidently expected victory.

Psalms 3:1-2 "Lord, how are they increased that trouble me! many are they that rise up against me. Many there be which say of my soul, There is no help for him in God. Selah.

Verse 5: "I will not be afraid of ten thousands of people, that have set themselves against me round about."

David had learned that the size of the problem should never affect his confidence in God or in his victory. He had a God-confidence that gave him peace even before the battle. He so believed that God would grant him success that he slept peacefully. Where most would be up in anxiety thinking about the impending battle and the emotional pain of his son trying to destroy him, he lies down and sleeps.

Psalms 3: 5, "I laid me down and slept; I awaked; for the LORD sustained me."

How confident are you in God? Has your confidence in God as the Source of Victory produced in you the by-product of God's Confidence? Are you resting in the face of some impending battle because you are confident that victory (salvation) is certain? **Remember this. True confidence in God will produce confidence in You!**

Practicing The Lessons

1. You cannot conquer what you won't confront. What do you need to confront and conquer?
2. Confront one thing at a time. Gain victory and get momentum before you attack the next thing.
3. Learn to ask the right questions. Ask questions that assume anything is possible and probable in your favor.
4. Monitor and manage the negativity that comes from others. Their seeds will become your weeds, so reject them and replace them with a positive statement.
5. Monitor and manage your thoughts. Choose faith and certainty over old doubts and fears.
6. Become a problem solver. What problems can you solve for the leader in your life?
7. Become heroic. What needs to be done, but no one is doing it? Step up to stand out.
8. Get in faith mode before you attack or attempt to win a battle.